



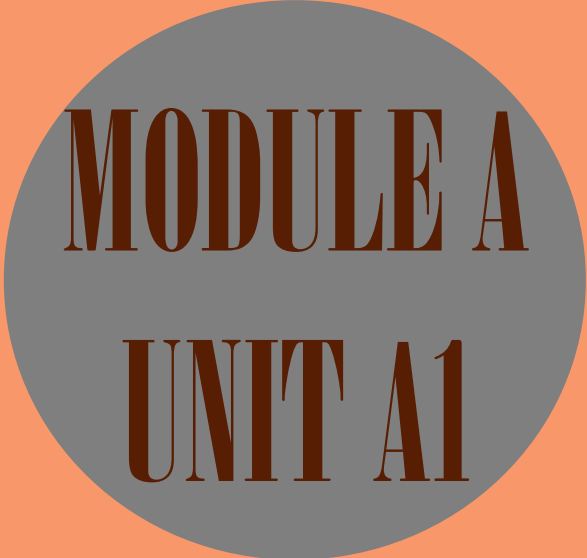
Universidad Tecnológica Nacional
Facultad Regional Villa María

INGLÉS 2

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MODULE A

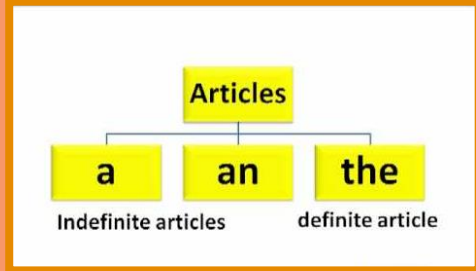
UNIT A1

Self-study Preview

Definite and indefinite articles:

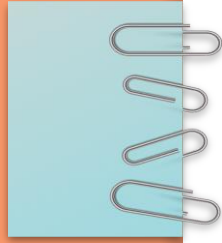
- ✓ <https://www.gymglish.com/es/gymglish/gramatica-inglesa/los-articulos-definidos-e-indefinidos> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <https://english.lingolia.com/es/gramatica/articulos> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <http://original.ompersonal.com.ar/INTERMEDIATE/unit16/page3.htm> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <http://original.ompersonal.com.ar/INTERMEDIATE/unit16/page4.htm> (Section: Grammar).

Articles



- English has two articles: “**the**” and “**a/an**”. *The* (also called **definite** article) is used to refer to specific or particular nouns; *a/an* (also - **indefinite** article) is used to modify non-specific or non-particular nouns.





If I say, "Let's read **a** book." → I mean *any* book rather than a specific book.

If I say, "Let's read **the** book." → I mean a *specific* book.

Both, writer / reader - speaker / listener know what book we are referring to.

The background image shows a wooden desk with a laptop, a cup of coffee, crumpled paper, and chopsticks. Overlaid on this is a large circle with a yellow border and a light blue inner ring. Inside the circle, the text 'Indefinite Articles' is written in white.

Indefinite Articles

Indefinite Articles

"A" and "an" signal that the noun modified is indefinite, referring to *any* member / thing of a group. Use the indefinite article for countable nouns in their singular form: For example:

Somebody call **a** police officer! (any police officer)

Mr Smith is staying in **a** hotel. (unspecified hotel)



A, An
(Articles)

First mention:

I saw **a**n old woman and **a** dog in the park.
Can you recommend **a** TV series?

Jobs:

Paula is **a** teacher and her brother is **a**n engineer.

Descriptions:

Paris is **a**n interesting city.
This will be **a** day to remember.

A is used when the next word begins with a **consonant sound** (**a** book, **a** clock, **a** university, **a** hospital, **a** one-month offer, etc.).

AN is used when the next word begins with a **vowel sound** (**a**n apple, **a**n engine, **a**n hour, **a**n FBI agent, **a**n x-ray, etc.).

Some other uses...

Use the indefinite article *a / an...*

- **before phrases of time and measurements:**

We have English once *a week*.

Tomatoes are \$5 *a kilo*.

- **After: half/quite:**

We need *half a* pound of sugar.

This is *quite a* good story.

- **Before: little/few:**

We really would like *a little* peace and quiet.

She likes *a few* songs by Frank Sinatra.



Definite Article

the



Definite Article

The main aim of the definite article is to identify 'something/someone specific' to the reader or listener. “**The**” is used before singular or plural, feminine or masculine nouns when the noun is specific or particular. “**The**” signals that the noun is definite, that it refers to a particular person, object, place, etc. of a group. For example:

I was happy to see **the** police officer who saved my brother!

Mr. Smith is staying in **the** hotel near the bank.





Second mention:

I talked to a man and a woman in the tour.
The woman was British and the man Chilean.

Specific nouns:

The children are in the garden.
Can you open the door?

**Only one thing /
person, etc.:**

The moon looks beautiful tonight.
Alex is the manager of this company.

Common places:

We are going to the park.
We must go to the bank tomorrow.



The

Superlatives:

You are the best students at UTN.
She is the most efficient employee here.

**Musical
instruments,
entertainment and
transport:**

I loved to play the violin when I was a child.
They are going to the opera tonight.

**Names of rivers,
seas, oceans,
mountain ranges
and deserts:**

We'll go on an expedition to the Andes.
I will go on a cruise down the Nile.

**Directions
(compass points):**

Look at the east and you can see the lake.
I prefer to travel to the north of Argentina.



Names of famous artworks, monuments:

I love the Starry Night by Vincent van Gogh.
The Statue of Liberty is in NYC.

Names of newspapers:

He reads the Guardian early in the morning.
She works for the New York Times.

Plural form of the name of a family (referring to all its members):

I met The Smiths yesterday.
The Simpsons are a very famous family.

Names of a group of people (nationality):

The British have an odd sense of humor.
Life can be very hard for the poor.



Zero article

~~A , An , The~~



Most continents /
countries / cities /
territories / streets:

Italy is amazing, I love that country.
Her hotel is on Merrion Street.

Days, months and
years:

I go to the gym on Mondays and Fridays.
World War II ended in 1945.

Institutions when
no talking about a
particular one:

Her children go to high school.
She's having hard times at prison.

Materials /
abstract nouns:

Paper is made of wood.
Life can be so complicated!

ZERO ARTICLE



Plural nouns that
refer to general
people/things:

I bought new pens and pencils at the store.
Cats' big eyes can see in the dark.

Languages and
nationalities:

English has many words of French origin.
Japanese are very intelligent people.

While mentioning
meals and food
(uncountable):

Mexican food is spicy.
Sometimes I have lunch at work.

With games and
sports.

She's good at tennis.
He played golf when he was 12.



Definite/Indefinite Article:

- https://www.myenglishpages.com/site_php_files/grammar-exercise-articles.php (Section: Exercises).
- <https://www.englishgrammar.org/definite-indefinite-articles-worksheet/> (Section: Exercises).
- https://www.english-grammar.at/online_exercises/articles/article1.htm (Section: Exercises).
- <https://test-english.com/grammar-points/a1/a-an-the-no-article/> (Section: Exercises).
- <https://agendaweb.org/exercises/grammar/articles/a-an-the-nothing.htm> (Section: Exercises).



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